Here's a step-by-step guide to install Laragon:

📥 Download Laragon

1. Go to the official website: laragon.org
2. Choose your version:
    - Laragon Full (recommended): Includes PHP, MySQL, Apache/Nginx, etc.
    - Laragon Portable: Can run from USB/external drives
3. Click the download button (usually around 50-100 MB)

🛠️ Installation Steps

Step 1: Run Installer

- Double-click the downloaded `.exe` file
- If prompted by Windows SmartScreen, click "More info" → "Run anyway"

Step 2: Choose Installation Type

Typical Installation (Recommended):
✓ PHP, MySQL, Apache/Nginx
✓ Composer, Git, Node.js

✓ All necessary components

Minimal:
✓ Only basic components
✓ Smaller download size

Step 3: Select Installation Path

- Default: `C:\laragon\`
- You can change it if needed (avoid paths with spaces)
- Portable users: Choose a folder on your USB/external drive

Step 4: Installation Options

Check these options during installation:

☑ Create Desktop Shortcut
☑ Add to PATH environment variable
☑ Associate .php files with Laragon

Step 5: Complete Installation

- Wait for installation to complete (5-10 minutes)
- Launch Laragon when finished

🚀 First Launch & Setup

Initial Configuration

1. Start Services: Click "Start All" button
2. Test Installation: Open browser → go to `http://localhost`
3. Check PHP Info: Go to `http://localhost/phpinfo.php`

Basic Settings (Optional)

Right-click Laragon tray icon → Settings:
• Auto Start: Enable if you want Laragon to start with Windows
• Nginx/Apache: Switch between web servers
• PHP Version: Change PHP version if multiple installed

📂 Creating Your First Project

Method 1: Quick Create

Right-click Laragon tray icon → Quick App
Choose: WordPress, Laravel, CodeIgniter, etc.

Right-click Laragon tray icon → Quick App
Choose: WordPress, Laravel, CodeIgniter, etc.

Method 2: Manual Create

1. Go to Laragon installation folder → `www` directory
2. Create new folder for your project
3. Add your PHP/HTML files
4. Access via: `http://yourprojectname.test`

🔧 Useful Commands & Features

Terminal Access

Right-click Laragon tray icon → Terminal
Opens Git Bash with Laragon paths configured

Right-click Laragon tray icon → Terminal
Opens Git Bash with Laragon paths configured

Database Management

- phpMyAdmin: `http://localhost/phpmyadmin`
- Adminer: `http://localhost/adminer.php`
- Default MySQL credentials:

Username: root
Password: (leave empty)

⚡ Tips & Tricks

Enable Pretty URLs

1. Go to Laragon Settings → General
2. Check: "Use Laragon's own URL convention"
3. Access projects as: `projectname.test` instead of `localhost/projectname`

Virtual Hosts

- All projects in `www` folder automatically become virtual hosts
- Access via: `projectname.test`

Port Conflicts

If port 80 is busy (Skype, IIS, etc.):

Settings → Ports → Change:
HTTP Port: 8080
HTTPS Port: 4433
Access via: http://localhost:8080